

JAVASCRIPT-BASED KEYBOARD LAYOUT



■ BUKYA SRIDHAR

Every computer system needs an input device to enter data. A keyboard is an electromechanical input device having switches and electronic parts. The key code processor in the keyboard senses the key pressed and generates a corresponding code which is sent to the central processing unit (CPU) of the system for execution. A mouse is another example of an input device. It acts as a pointing device and generates code corresponding to the button that is pressed.

Here is a program that displays the codes for each key and mouse button pressed. It may be useful when troubleshooting a keyboard problem, or reading keyboard or mouse inputs directly from the software code.

Software program

The keyboard.htm program requires Internet Explorer browser in your PC. When you double-click the keyboard.htm file, a Windows security warning message appears on the screen (refer Screenshot 1). Click 'Allow Blocked Content...' option to run the program.

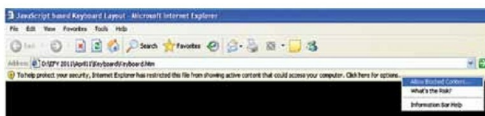
When you click the mouse or press a key on the keyboard, the system inside the mouse/keyboard interprets the click/key pressed and sends an ASCII code, which is read by the microprocessor (CPU).

The ASCII code is nothing but a code sequence developed by American National Standards Institute. It is a hexadecimal equivalent of the clumsy binary code that can be easily understood. ASCII stands for 'American Standard Code for Information

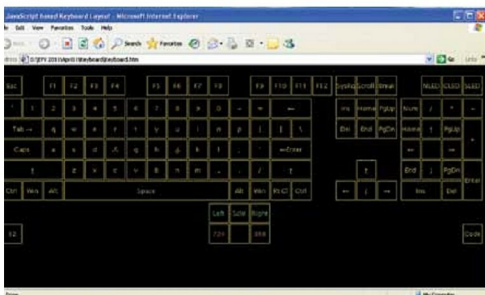
Interchange.'

For example, when space bar key

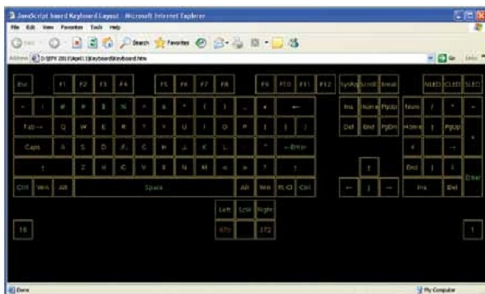
is pressed, hexadecimal code '%20' is sent to the processor. This hexa-



Screenshot 1: Windows security warning message



Screenshot 2: Program output displaying code '%20' for spacebar key



Screenshot 3: Program output displaying code '1' for left button of the mouse